

2. THE CYLINDER OF CYRUS¹

(1) his troops (2) . . . quarters of the world (3) . . . a weakling was established in rule over the land (4) *and* . . . a similar one he appointed over them, (5) like E-saggil he made . . . to Ur and the rest of the cities, (6) a command dishonoring them . . . he planned daily and in enmity, (7) he caused the daily offering to cease; he appointed . . . he established within the city. The worship of Marduk, king of the gods . . . (8) he showed hostility toward his city daily . . . his *people* he brought all of them to ruin through servitude without rest. (9) On account of their complaints the lord of the gods became furiously angry and *left* their land; the gods, who dwelt among them, left their homes, (10) in anger over his bringing into Babylon. Marduk . . . to all the dwelling places, which had become ruins, (11) and the people of Sumer and Akkad, who were like corpses . . . he turned and granted

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(1) . . . -ni-šu (2) [. -ki]-ib-ra-tim (3) -ka gal ma-tu-ú iš-šak-na a-na e-nu-tu ma-ti-šu (4) ši-[-. ta-am]-ši-li ú-ša-aš-ki-na ši-ru-šu-un (5) ta-am-ši-li É-sag-ila i-te-[-. -ti]m a-na Uri(ki) ù si-it-ta-tim ma-ḫa-za (6) pa-ra-aš la si-ma-a-ti-šu-nu ta-[-. -l]i ú-mi-ša-am-ma id-di-ni-ib-bu-ub ù ana na-ak-ri-tim (7) sat-tuk-ku ù-šab-ti-li ú-ad-[di iš]-tak-ka-an ki-rib ma-ḫa-zi pa-la-ḫa (ilu) Marduk šar ilâni [šá]-ki-še a-šu-uš-šu (8) li-mu-ut-ti ali-šu [i-te]-ni-ip-pu-uš ú-mi-ša-am-ma na-[-. niše] i-na ab-ša-a-ni la ta-ap-šu-úḫ-tim ú-ḫal-li-ik kul-lat-si-in (9) a-na ta-zi-im-ti-ši-na (ilu) Ellil (lil) ilani iz-zi-iš i-gu-ug-ma ki-su-úr-šu-un ilâni a-ši-ib lib-bi-šu-nu i-zi-bu ad-ma-an-šu-un (10) i-na ug-ga-ti šá ú-še-ri-bi a-na ki-rib Babili (ilu) Marduk ti- li-sa-aḫ-ra a-na nap-ḫar da-ád-mi šá in-na-du-ú šú-bat-su-un (11) ù niše mât Šú-me-ri ù Akkadi(ki) ša i-mu-ú ša-lam-ta-aš ú-sa-aḫ-bi-ir ka- -ši ir-ta-ši ta-a-a-ra kul-lat ma-ta-a-ta ka-li-ši-na i-bi-iḫ ib-ri-e